

Linux & SSH Command Reference

OverTheWire Bandit — Levels 0–33 | June 2026

SSH & Connection

Command	What it does
<code>ssh user@host -p 2220</code>	Connect to remote server
<code>ssh -i keyfile user@host -p 2220</code>	Connect using private key
<code>exit</code> / <code>Ctrl+D</code>	Close SSH session cleanly

File Navigation

Command	What it does
<code>ls</code>	List files
<code>ls -la</code>	List all files including hidden, with details
<code>cd directory</code>	Change directory
<code>cat filename</code>	Print file contents
<code>cat ./filename</code>	Cat a file starting with special characters
<code>cat "file with spaces"</code>	Cat a file with spaces in name
<code>file filename</code>	Check what type a file is

Finding Files

Command	What it does
<code>find / -user x -group y -size 33c</code>	Find file by owner, group, size
<code>find inhere -type f -size 1033c ! -executable</code>	Find by size, not executable
<code>2>/dev/null</code>	Hide permission denied errors

Text Processing

Command	What it does
<code>grep word file</code>	Search for word in file
<code>sort file</code>	Sort lines alphabetically
<code>uniq -u</code>	Show only unique lines
<code>strings file</code>	Extract readable text from binary
<code>base64 -d file</code>	Decode base64 encoded data
<code>tr 'A-Za-z' 'N-ZA-Mn-za-m'</code>	ROT13 decode
<code>diff file1 file2</code>	Show differences between two files

Compression

Command	What it does
<code>gzip -d file.gz</code>	Decompress gzip
<code>bzip2 -d file.bz2</code>	Decompress bzip2
<code>tar xf file</code>	Extract tar archive

Command	What it does
<code>xxd -r file</code>	Convert hexdump back to binary

Networking

Command	What it does
<code>nc host port</code>	Connect to a port
<code>nc -l -p 1234</code>	Listen on a port
<code>echo "text" nc host port</code>	Send text to a port
<code>telnet host port</code>	Connect via telnet
<code>openssl s_client -connect host:port</code>	Connect via SSL
<code>nmap -sV -p 31000-32000 localhost</code>	Scan port range

Permissions & Execution

Command	What it does
<code>./binary</code>	Execute a binary in current directory
<code>./setuid-binary command</code>	Run command as binary's owner
<code>man command</code>	Full manual for any command
<code>command --help</code>	Quick help for any command

Cron Jobs

Command	What it does
<code>cat /etc/cron.d/</code>	List all scheduled cron jobs
<code>cat /etc/cron.d/cronjob_bandit22</code>	Read a specific cron job
<code>cat /usr/bin/script.sh</code>	Read the script a cron job runs
<code>* * * * *</code>	Cron format: min hour day month weekday
<code>0 * * * *</code>	Run every hour (at minute 0)
<code>0 0 * * *</code>	Run every day at midnight

Scripting & Variables

Command	What it does
<code>myname=\$(whoami)</code>	Store command output in a variable
<code>echo I am user \$myname md5sum</code>	Hash a string with MD5
<code>cut -d ' ' -f 1</code>	Cut output to first field (trim spaces)
<code>cat > file.sh << 'EOF'</code>	Create a script file using heredoc
<code>chmod +x script.sh</code>	Make a script executable
<code>\$0</code>	Reference to current shell (escape restricted shells)

Brute Forcing

Command	What it does
<code>for i in \$(seq -w 0000 9999)</code>	Loop through 0000 to 9999

Command	What it does
<code>echo 'password 1234' nc localhost 30002</code>	Send pin attempt to port
<code>grep -v Wrong</code>	Filter out wrong attempt lines

Shell Escaping

Command	What it does
<code>cat /etc/passwd grep bandit26</code>	Check a user's default shell
<code>v</code> (inside more)	Open current file in vim
<code>:set shell=/bin/bash</code>	Set shell in vim
<code>:shell</code>	Spawn a shell from vim
<code>:q!</code>	Force quit vim without saving
<code>:e /etc/bandit_pass/bandit26</code>	Open a file directly in vim

Git Commands

Command	What it does
<code>git clone ssh://user@host:port/path</code>	Clone a remote repository
<code>git clone <url> C:\path\to\folder</code>	Clone to a specific local path
<code>git log</code>	Show commit history
<code>git log -p</code>	Show commit history with changes (patch)
<code>git branch -a</code>	List all branches including remote
<code>git checkout branchname</code>	Switch to a different branch

Command	What it does
<code>git tag</code>	List all tags
<code>git show tagname</code>	Show contents of a tag
<code>git add -f filename</code>	Force add a file (bypass .gitignore)
<code>git commit -m "message"</code>	Commit staged changes
<code>git push origin master</code>	Push commits to remote
<code>git reset --hard origin/master</code>	Reset local branch to remote state
<code>git status</code>	Show staged and unstaged changes
<code>git config --global user.email x</code>	Set git email identity
<code>git config --global user.name x</code>	Set git username identity
<code>type .gitignore</code>	Check what files are ignored by git

Windows CMD & File Creation

Command	What it does
<code>cls</code>	Clear CMD screen
Right-click	Paste in CMD
<code>type filename</code>	Windows equivalent of cat
<code>echo text > file.txt</code>	Create file with text (adds newline)
<code>powershell -Command "[System.IO.File]::WriteAllText('file.txt', 'content')"</code>	Create file without trailing newline